published Greenwald's second article about an NSA mass-surveillance program called PRISM. That same day, a different article about PRISM appeared in the *Washington Post*, written by Barton Gellman, a journalist Snowden had previously contacted. Then, on June 8, the *Guardian* published Greenwald's third story, about an NSA data mining tool code named Boundless Informant.

## Watching and Waiting

Sitting in his Hong Kong hotel room, Snowden watched television and monitored the Internet as the disclosures emerged. The first article was the lead story on every US national news broadcast. Finally, the debate he had so long hoped to generate was happening; he had no idea whether anyone in the public would care.

But his relief was quickly tempered by threats of prosecution issuing from Washington, DC. President Obama, legislators, Intelligence Community officials, and news pundits were saying surveillance programs were necessary for homeland security. They also said what the leaker had done—stealing top secrets—was highly illegal. The reaction was not a surprise to Snowden, and he expected the US government would

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